

USHERING IN A NEW HORIZON: DHAMI GOVERNMENT'S VISIONARY APPROACH WITH THE FIRST-EVER DRONE POLICY

Uttarakhand, renowned for its profound spiritual, religious, and cultural heritage, is embarking on a journey towards technological prowess. This transformation hasn't been sudden; rather, it's the result of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's guidance and Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami's unwavering efforts.

Under the visionary leadership of the CM, the Uttarakhand government has forged a groundbreaking model of development, encompassing even the most unconventional avenues. One such pioneering realm is drone technology. On August 3, under the leadership of Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, the state cabinet granted approval for Uttarakhand's first drone policy. This not only paves the way for increased investment but also opens up new employment opportunities within the state.

The Dhami government has set forth an ambitious goal of attracting a staggering one thousand crore rupees in investments through the formulation of this drone policy. Simultaneously, it aims to generate employment prospects for around five thousand people, fostering self-employment opportunities for an equal number of skilled drone pilots. The policy seamlessly integrates the drone regulations established by the central government in 2021. Provision of special subsidies has also been made to promote drone manufacturing, and drone services in the state.

Drone technology will be widely used in key economic sectors such as agriculture, mining, infrastructure, campus surveillance, emergency response, transportation, geospatial mapping, traffic management, and law enforcement. In addition, drone manufacturing, research, development, training, repair, and maintenance will be encouraged in the state. Arrangements have also been made in the policy to encourage the cooperation of drones in government work, drone corridors, and drone traffic management.

THIS IS HOW DRONE POLICY WILL GAIN TRACTION

- In order to ensure the effective implementation of the drone policy, a "State Drone Committee" is set to be established, under the chairmanship of the Chief Secretary. It will include the Secretary IT, Secretary Finance, Secretary Planning, Secretary Home, CEO of Uttarakhand Civil Aviation Development Authority (UCADA), Director of Information Technology Development Agency (ITDA), State Officer of 'Drone Implementation' as members. Additionally, officers nominated by the secretary and chief secretary of other important departments will be special invitees.
- With the unveiling of the drone policy, both renowned Indian and international companies will be lured to invest in Uttarakhand. According to the policy, there will be an investment of Rs 500 crore in the drone manufacturing industry and Rs 500 crore in the drone service sector. An anticipated annual



> “Uttarakhand is a very complex state in terms of geographical conditions, and here drone technology can prove to be very effective. The country's first Drone Application Research Center (DARK) has been established in Uttarakhand.”
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> ***— Pushkar Singh Dhami***
> ***Chief Minister, Uttarakhand***

